

KOFI AMPOMA ASUAKO, Ph.D.

*International
Macro-Financial Economist*

CONTACT

LOCATION

Columbia, South Carolina, USA

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LINKEDIN

kofi-asuako

WEBSITE

kofiampomaasuako.com

TECHNICAL SKILLS

PROGRAMMING

Julia, Python, MATLAB, Stata, EViews,
R (intermediate)

MODELLING

DSGE, Bayesian & structural VARs,
panel-data econometrics, nowcasting &
mixed-frequency methods, scenario &
risk analysis

TOOLS

LaTeX, Microsoft Office, policy-note &
briefing writing

LANGUAGES

ENGLISH

Fluent, professional working language

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a macroeconomist whose research focuses on macro-financial stability and the design of monetary policy frameworks. I use structural models and empirical methods to examine how the macroeconomic policy mix, credit market conditions, and financial-sector dynamics generate vulnerabilities in the banking sector and how these vulnerabilities, in turn, affect business cycles, asset prices, and the broader economy. My research is motivated by questions of financial resilience, policy coordination, and macroeconomic stability. Drawing on practical banking experience in credit and risk analysis, I also bring an applied perspective to economic research and communicate complex findings clearly to policymakers and financial institutions.

RESEARCH & POLICY EXPERTISE

- International macroeconomic surveillance
- Monetary policy and inflation dynamics
- Fiscal policy and sovereign debt
- DSGE & Bayesian structural estimation
- Near-term forecasting and nowcasting
- Global shocks and cross-border spillovers
- Macro-financial linkages & systemic risk
- Senior-level policy communication

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics

*Southern Illinois University Carbondale
Fields: Macroeconomics & Finance*

Aug 2021 - Aug 2025

Carbondale, IL

Dissertation: *Fiscal Dominance and Bank Fragility in Frontier Economies: Theory and Evidence from Sub-Saharan Africa.*

M.A. in Economics

*Eastern Illinois University
Fields: International & Managerial Economics*

Aug 2019 - May 2021

Charleston, IL

Thesis: *Trade Integration and Economic Growth in Africa: Lessons from SADC and ECOWAS.*

B.A. in Economics, Minor in History

*Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology
Fields: Economics*

Sep 2013 - Jul 2017

Kumasi, Ghana

Thesis: *The Effect of External Debt on Economic Growth in Ghana: An Econometric Analysis.*

REFERENCES

Dr. Zsolt Becsi
Dissertation Advisor; Associate Professor, SIU Carbondale
becsi@siu.edu
(618) 453-5067

Dr. Kevin Sylwester
Professor & Director, School of Analytics, Finance, and Economics, SIU Carbondale
ksylwest@siu.edu
(618) 453-5075

Dr. Alison Watts
Professor of Economics, SIU Carbondale
watts@siu.edu
(618) 453-5073

Dr. Scott Gilbert
Associate Professor of Economics, SIU Carbondale
gilberts@siu.edu
(618) 453-5095

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant Professor of Economics <i>Allen University</i>	Aug 2025 - Present Columbia, SC, USA
Graduate Instructor & Research Assistant <i>Southern Illinois University Carbondale</i>	Aug 2021 - May 2025 Carbondale, IL, USA
Graduate Instructor <i>Eastern Illinois University</i>	Aug 2019 - May 2021 Charleston, IL, USA
Credit Analyst <i>Ejuranan Rural Bank, Ghana</i>	Jan 2019 - Jul 2019 Kumasi, Ghana
Teaching & Research Assistant <i>Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology</i>	Aug 2017 - Aug 2018 Kumasi, Ghana
Research Intern <i>Ecobank Ghana Ltd.</i>	May 2016 - Aug 2016 Kumasi, Ghana

COURSES TAUGHT AT ALLEN UNIVERSITY

- Undergraduate**
- FIN 121 - Personal Finance
 - ECON 201 - Principles of Microeconomics
 - ECO 202 - Principles of Macroeconomics
 - FIN 361 - Investment Management and Securities Valuation
 - FIN 460 - Financial Statement Analysis
 - FIN 461 - Risk Management and Insurance
- Graduate / MBA**
- BUS 513 - Managerial Statistics
 - BUS 517 - Quantitative Analysis

RESEARCH AGENDA & POLICY RELEVANCE

- **Money-Financed Government Deficits and Bank Fragility in Frontier Economies.**
Forthcoming in African Review of Economics & Finance.
- **Structural Drivers of Sovereign Lending Bias: Why Banks Lend More to Governments Than the Private Sector in Frontier African Economies.**
Research in Progress.
- **Macroprudential Policy and Credit Cycles in Emerging Markets.**
Research in Progress.

CONFERENCES & PROFESSIONAL MEETINGS

- Missouri Valley Economic Association - Presenter, October 24-26, 2024; October 23-25, 2025.
- AltFinance 2025 Workshop, The Wharton School - Participant, September 5-6, 2025.
- American Economic Association (ASSA Annual Meeting) - Participant, January 6-8, 2023; January 5-7, 2024; January 3-5, 2025.